



Ori, the robotic furniture

Short word for origami, Ori is a new robotic furniture that can transform its shape at the push of a button. Learn more: <http://digit.in/OriFurniture>



Battle.net is here to stay

Recognising the confusion, Blizzard announces that they will be reverting their gaming platform to Blizzard Battle.net. <http://digit.in/Blizzardnet>



Is VR finally mainstream?

Agent001 is in two minds over the entire virtual reality phenomenon.

agent001 | agent001@digit.in

It's been going on for a couple of years now. At first, 2015 was touted to be the year of VR, that passed onto the year 2016 and now we are nine months into 2017, but the VR phenomenon is yet to catch on. And it's not just India, but the entire world as a whole that's staying away from VR. Before VR became the poster child of content producers and hardware manufacturers, the 3D phenomenon was the most promising. Every mainstream television manufacturer had jumped on board and brought out several 3D capable TVs but the content simply wasn't up to the mark. The sheer amount of investment needed for mainstream content producers such as sports, news and TV shows, to produce 3D content alongside the existing programming schedule did not work out. Heck, we don't even see that many 3D TVs in the market any more. It's all about curved panels and higher colour depth these days as 10-bit becomes more popular. So why is VR lagging behind?

The obvious thing is that there is a bottleneck which is impeding the adoption of VR across the board and I'm more inclined towards placing the blame on hardware manufacturers for not moving as fast as they can. There is a significant amount of investment in R&D that has led to the production of

the HTC Vive, Oculus Rift and PlayStation VR. And the companies behind these gadgets want to make good on their investment and they're doing so by charging a massive premium on the headsets that they make. The fact that both Oculus and HTC were able to cut prices for \$200 on both their devices attests to this massive markup. Honestly, I see why any technology company under the sun would want to charge such a premium for their products. On one end, they're charging

game titles in the market that could be played and were not in any "Early Access" state. Cut short to July 2017 and we have more than 500 VR titles. Most of which are very pedestrian but nevertheless, the efforts are paying off.

While the amount of content is certainly on an upswing, the pricing of these headsets has ensured that these titles remain outside the purview of most gamers. So it's still the early adopters who're buying these headsets. Us Indians can completely forget



HTC Vive

a lot of money for their headsets and on the other end they're actively wooing content producers with funding to build an ecosystem for VR. Facebook just pledged another \$250 million, thus, making their total pledge a cool \$500 million. Just a year back, in March 2016, there were only 30 VR

game titles in the market that could be played and were not in any "Early Access" state. Cut short to July 2017 and we have more than 500 VR titles. Most of which are very pedestrian but nevertheless, the efforts are paying off. While the amount of content is certainly on an upswing, the pricing of these headsets has ensured that these titles remain outside the purview of most gamers. So it's still the early adopters who're buying these headsets. Us Indians can completely forget